

Complete Theme

Vocabulary — 23 words

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
regret <i>noun/verb</i>	/rɪˈɡret/	pişmanlık, pişman olmak	She still feels regret about not calling her grandmother more often.
criticise <i>verb</i>	/ˈkrɪtɪsaɪz/	eleştirmek	His friends criticised him for hiding his problems instead of talking about them.
open up <i>phrasal verb</i>	/ˈoʊpən ʌp/	içini dökmek, açılmak	It took months before he felt ready to open up about his feelings.
bottle up <i>phrasal verb</i>	/ˈbɒtl ʌp/	içine atmak (duyguları)	She had bottled up her worries for so long that she finally broke down in tears.
confide <i>verb</i>	/kənˈfaɪd/	sır vermek, güvenip anlatmak	He decided to confide in his older brother about the argument.
burden <i>noun</i>	/ˈbɜːrden/	yük	Carrying that secret alone became a heavy burden for her.
assumption <i>noun</i>	/əˈsʌmpʃn/	varsayım	It was a wrong assumption to think he wasn't interested in helping.
misunderstanding <i>noun</i>	/ˌmɪsʌndərˈstændɪŋ/	yanlış anlaşılma	The whole argument started because of a small misunderstanding.
guilt <i>noun</i>	/ɡɪlt/	suçluluk duygusu	He was full of guilt after realising how much he had hurt his sister.
sympathetic <i>adjective</i>	/ˌsɪmpəˈθetɪk/	anlayışlı, sempatik	Her teacher was very sympathetic when she explained why she had missed classes.
vulnerable <i>adjective</i>	/ˈvʌlnərəbl/	savunmasız, kırılgan	Sharing your true feelings can make you feel vulnerable at first.
reassure <i>verb</i>	/ˌriːəˈʃʊr/	güvence vermek, rahatlatmak	His mother reassured him that everyone makes mistakes sometimes.
resentment <i>noun</i>	/rɪˈzentmənt/	kızgınlık, gücenme	Years of silence had turned into quiet resentment between the two friends.
overreact <i>verb</i>	/ˌoʊvəriˈækt/	aşırı tepki vermek	Looking back, he admitted that he had overreacted to a small comment.
hold a grudge <i>expression</i>	/hoʊld ə ɡrʌdʒ/	kin tutmak	She refused to hold a grudge and forgave her brother the next day.

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considerate <i>adjective</i>	/kən'sɪdərət/	düşünceli, saygılı	He should have been more considerate when he cancelled the plan at the last minute.
thoughtless <i>adjective</i>	/ˈθɔːtləs/	düşüncesiz	It was thoughtless of her to read his private messages without asking.
make amends <i>expression</i>	/meɪk ə'mendz/	telafl etmek, özür dileyip düzeltmek	He tried to make amends by apologising and helping her move.
genuine <i>adjective</i>	/ˈdʒenjuɪn/	samimi, gerçek	Her apology sounded genuine, so he decided to forgive her.
distant <i>adjective</i>	/ˈdɪstənt/	mesafeli, soğuk (davranışta)	He noticed his friend had become distant after the argument.
excuse <i>noun/verb</i>	/ɪk'skjuːs/	bahane, mazur görmek	There was no real excuse for forgetting her birthday.
consequence <i>noun</i>	/ˈkɒnsɪkwəns/	sonuç	He didn't think about the consequences before sending the angry message.
heartfelt <i>adjective</i>	/ˈhɑːrtfelt/	içten, yürekten	She wrote a heartfelt letter explaining why she had been so quiet lately.

Should have / Could have (criticism and regret about the past)

We use should have + past participle to criticise a past action that did not happen but would have been the right thing to do. We use shouldn't have + past participle to criticise something that did happen but was the wrong thing to do. We use could have + past participle to talk about a possible action in the past that was not taken.

Geçmişte yapılmayan ama yapılması gereken bir davranışı eleştirmek için should have + fiil3 kullanılır.

Geçmişte yapılan ama yapılmaması gereken bir davranışı eleştirmek için shouldn't have + fiil3 kullanılır.

Geçmişte mümkün olduğu hâlde yapılmayan bir eylemden bahsetmek için ise could have + fiil3 kullanılır.

When? Use this structure when giving advice about the past, expressing regret, or criticising a decision that cannot be changed anymore.

Geçmişle ilgili tavsiye verirken, pişmanlık ifade ederken veya artık değiştirilemeyecek bir kararı eleştirirken bu yapı kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + should/could + have + past participle
- You should have listened to her.

Negative

- Subject + shouldn't/couldn't + have + past participle
- You shouldn't have said that.

Question

- Should/Could + subject + have + past participle?
- Should I have called him first?

Short answers

- Yes, you should have. / No, you shouldn't have.

Common mistakes

- ~~You should have went to the doctor.~~ → **You should have gone to the doctor.**
- ~~I should to have called her.~~ → **I should have called her.**

1. You _____ so rude to your classmate yesterday.

- a. shouldn't have been
- b. shouldn't be
- c. don't have to be
- d. can't be

2. She _____ (apologise) right away, but she waited two days.

3. 'I should studied harder for the exam.' is a correct sentence. — *True / False*

4. Which sentence expresses regret about something NOT done?

- a. You shouldn't have shouted.
- b. I should have called her.
- c. He shouldn't have left early.
- d. They shouldn't have lied.

5. Rewrite using could have: It was possible for him to ask for help, but he didn't. (He ____)

6. Put the words in order: have / you / shouldn't / that / said

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7. We _____ (not / assume) she was angry; we never asked her.

8. Choose the sentence with the correct meaning: 'You could have texted me.'

- a. It was necessary for you to text me.
- b. It was possible for you to text me, but you didn't.
- c. You definitely texted me.
- d. You are texting me now.

9. Rewrite as criticism using shouldn't have: It was wrong of them to hold a grudge for so long. (They ____)

Might have / Must have / Couldn't have (degrees of certainty about the past)

We use must have + past participle when we are almost certain about a past event based on evidence. We use might have + past participle when we are not sure and are only guessing at a possibility. We use couldn't have + past participle when we are certain something was impossible in the past.

Geçmişte olan bir olay hakkında kanıtlara dayanarak neredeyse emin olduğumuzda must have + fiil3 kullanılır. Emin olmadığımız, sadece bir olasılığı tahmin ettiğimiz durumlarda might have + fiil3 kullanılır. Geçmişte bir şeyin imkânsız olduğundan emin olduğumuzda ise couldn't have + fiil3 kullanılır.

When? Use this structure when speculating about a past event, explaining evidence, or ruling out an impossible explanation.

Geçmişteki bir olay hakkında tahminde bulunurken, kanıtları açıklarken veya imkânsız bir açıklamayı elerken bu yapı kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + must/might + have + past participle
- He must have left early.

Negative

- Subject + might not/couldn't + have + past participle
- She couldn't have known that.

Question

- Rarely used in questions; guesses are usually expressed as statements: 'Do you think she might have forgotten?'

Short answers

- She might have. / No, she couldn't have.

Common mistakes

- ~~He must have went home.~~ → **He must have gone home.**
- ~~She can't have knew about it.~~ → **She couldn't have known about it.**

1. The door is locked and no lights are on. They _____ home yet.

- a. mustn't have gone
- b. can't have gone
- c. must have gone
- d. might have gone

2. I'm not sure, but she _____ (forget) our plans.

3. 'He couldn't have seen us; he was on the other side of the city.' expresses certainty that something was impossible. — True / False

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4. Which modal expresses the strongest certainty about a past event?

- a. might have
- b. could have (possibility)
- c. must have
- d. may have

5. Rewrite to express impossibility: It's impossible that she said that. (*She* ____)

6. Put the words in order: have / must / been / it / difficult

7. Choose the sentence that best expresses an uncertain guess about the past.

- a. He must have left already.
- b. He couldn't have left already.
- c. He might have left already.
- d. He has left already.

8. They _____ (not / hear) us; the music was too loud.

The Letter I Never Sent

Before you read

- Have you ever wanted to say sorry to someone but didn't know how to start?
- What makes it hard for people to open up about their feelings?

For almost a year, Deniz and her best friend Ela hadn't spoken. It all started with a small misunderstanding that neither of them had bothered to clear up. Deniz often thought about what she should have done differently. She should have called Ela the same evening instead of waiting for an apology that never came. Looking back, she realised she could have simply asked what had happened instead of assuming the worst.

One evening, Deniz decided to write a letter. She wrote about how she had bottled up her feelings for months, afraid that opening up would make her seem weak. She admitted that she shouldn't have ignored Ela's messages at the beginning, even though she was hurt. She also wrote that Ela must have felt confused when the replies suddenly stopped; there was no other explanation that made sense.

As she wrote, Deniz thought about all the small clues she had missed. Ela had seemed distant at school, and her friends said she looked tired and quiet. Deniz guessed that Ela might have been dealing with something difficult at home, something she couldn't have known about at the time. She felt a wave of guilt. She should have asked instead of staying silent.

In the end, Deniz never sent the letter by post. Instead, she read it aloud to Ela in person, her voice shaking. Ela listened quietly and then said she, too, wished she could have handled things differently. Neither of them had been a bad friend; they had simply been too proud to be vulnerable. By the end of their conversation, the heavy burden both girls had carried for months finally felt lighter.

1. Why hadn't Deniz and Ela spoken for almost a year?
 - a. They had a small misunderstanding they never cleared up.
 - b. They moved to different schools.
 - c. Ela was angry about a birthday present.
 - d. Deniz forgot Ela's phone number.
2. Deniz sent the letter to Ela by post. — *True / False*
3. Deniz guessed that Ela _____ (deal) with something difficult at home.
4. According to the text, what does Deniz criticise herself for?
 - a. Not calling Ela the same evening
 - b. Telling other people about the argument
 - c. Writing too many letters
 - d. Being too talkative at school
5. Rewrite using couldn't have: It was impossible for Deniz to know about Ela's problems at home. (*Deniz ____*)

6. What does the phrase 'a heavy burden' most likely refer to in the text?

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- a. A physical object Deniz carried
 - b. The emotional weight of their unresolved conflict
 - c. A school assignment
 - d. A family responsibility

After you read

- What could Deniz have done earlier to avoid a whole year of silence?
- Do you think writing a letter is a good way to open up? Why or why not?

Who Forgot the Cake?

Before you read

- Think of a time when something went wrong and people started guessing who was responsible.
- What clues do we usually use to guess what happened?

When the Aydın family arrived at their grandmother's 70th birthday party, everyone realised the cake was missing. Panic spread quickly through the kitchen. Someone must have forgotten to pick it up from the bakery, but nobody wanted to admit it. Uncle Kemal insisted he couldn't have forgotten, since he had written the reminder himself on a sticky note stuck to the fridge.

Cousin Aslı suggested that their younger cousin Mert might have taken the sticky note down while cleaning the kitchen that morning. Mert denied it firmly, saying he hadn't touched anything near the fridge. Still, his sister remembered seeing him near the fridge earlier, so he might have moved the note without even noticing.

Meanwhile, Grandma sat calmly in her armchair, smiling. She said it didn't really matter who should have picked up the cake. What mattered more, she explained, was that everyone had come together, worried and a little chaotic, just to make her day special. She reminded them that a missing cake couldn't have ruined a celebration built on love and family.

In the end, they discovered that the bakery itself must have made the mistake — they had accidentally given the cake to another family with a similar name. Everyone laughed with relief. Uncle Kemal joked that he should have called to confirm the order the night before, just to be safe next time. They ordered pizza instead and turned the missing cake into the best story of the year.

1. What was Uncle Kemal's argument for why he couldn't have forgotten the cake?

- a. He never uses sticky notes.
- b. He wrote the reminder himself and stuck it to the fridge.
- c. He doesn't like cake.
- d. He was not at home that morning.

2. Mert _____ (move) the note without noticing, according to his sister.

3. The bakery gave the cake to the wrong family. — *True / False*

4. What did Grandma say mattered more than the missing cake?

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- a. Finding out who was guilty
 - b. Everyone coming together for her
 - c. Buying a new cake quickly
 - d. Getting a refund from the bakery

5. Rewrite using should have: It would have been wise for Kemal to call and confirm the order. (*Kemal* ____)

After you read

- Why do you think the family jumped to conclusions before knowing the real reason?
- How does the story show the difference between guessing (might have) and being certain (must have)?

A Difficult Conversation

Before you listen

- What would you say to a friend who hurt your feelings without realising it?
- Listen for how each speaker expresses regret or criticism.

1. Why was Buse upset with Kaan?

- a. He forgot her birthday.
- b. He made a joke about her presentation in front of the class.
- c. He didn't invite her to the party.
- d. He lost her notes.

2. Kaan says he _____ (misread) the situation completely.

3. Buse told Kaan she was upset immediately after the joke. — *True / False*

4. What does Kaan say he could have done instead of making a joke?

- a. Stayed silent
- b. Complimented her work
- c. Left the party early
- d. Asked someone else to speak

The Empty Classroom

Before you listen

- Predict: why might a classroom be left in a mess after school?
- Listen for guesses (might have/must have) and impossible explanations (couldn't have).

1. What was the classroom like in the morning?

- a. Clean and tidy
- b. A complete mess with chairs and papers everywhere
- c. Locked and empty
- d. Full of new furniture

2. Student A says the mess _____ (be) their class because they left it tidy.

3. The cleaning staff were responsible for the mess. — *True / False*

4. What does Student A say the drama club shouldn't have done?

- a. Used the room for rehearsal
- b. Left the room like that without telling anyone
- c. Cancelled the rehearsal
- d. Locked the door

Detectives of the Past

Groups of 3-4 · 10 min

In groups, look at a short mystery situation (e.g. a broken window, a missing notebook, a surprise party ruined) and discuss what might have, must have, or couldn't have happened, giving reasons for your guesses.

Useful language: It must have been..., It might have been..., It couldn't have been... because..., That would explain why..., I'm not so sure about that because...

1. In groups, choose one mystery situation from the teacher's list.
2. Brainstorm at least three possible explanations using might have.
3. Agree on the explanation you think is most likely (must have) and one you can rule out (couldn't have).
4. Present your group's reasoning to the class in two minutes.

I Wish I Had Said Something

Pairs · 8 min

In pairs, take turns describing a real or invented situation where you feel you should have or could have acted differently, while your partner gives gentle advice or agrees with your reflection.

Useful language: I should have..., I could have..., Looking back, I shouldn't have..., In your place, I might have..., It's understandable that you...

1. Think of a small past situation (a missed chance, a small conflict, an unfinished task).
2. Share it with your partner using should have / could have to express what you would do differently now.
3. Your partner listens and responds with a supportive comment or their own similar experience.
4. Swap roles and repeat.

Writing

A Letter I Never Sent

120-150 words

Write a short letter to someone (a friend, family member, or classmate) explaining a past situation you regret and what you should have or could have done differently.

Plan:

1. Decide who the letter is to and what the situation was.
2. List 2-3 things you regret or should have done.
3. Think about how the situation made you feel and what you learned.
4. Plan a closing line that shows how you feel now.

Checklist:

- ☐ I used should have / shouldn't have / could have correctly.
- ☐ I explained the situation clearly.
- ☐ I included how I feel now.
- ☐ My letter is within the word limit.

The Mystery of the Missing Gift

130-160 words

Write a short paragraph speculating about what happened to a missing item (e.g. a birthday gift, a phone, a set of keys), using might have, must have, and couldn't have to explain different theories.

Plan:

1. Decide what item is missing and where it was last seen.
2. Brainstorm at least three possible explanations.
3. Order your ideas from least to most likely.
4. End with the explanation you believe is most probable.

Checklist:

- ☐ I included at least three different modal perfect structures.
- ☐ My guesses are logical and based on clues.
- ☐ I reached a clear conclusion at the end.
- ☐ My paragraph is within the word limit.

1. You look tired. You _____ late last night.
 - a. must have stayed up
 - b. should stay up
 - c. can stay up
 - d. stay up
2. I _____ (apologise) sooner; I feel bad about waiting so long.
3. 'Bottle up' means to talk openly about your feelings. — *True / False*
4. Which word means 'to share private feelings or secrets with someone'?
 - a. criticise
 - b. confide
 - c. reassure
 - d. overreact
5. Rewrite using couldn't have: It's impossible that he lied to us. (*He ____*)
6. In 'The Letter I Never Sent', what does Deniz eventually do?
 - a. She sends the letter by post.
 - b. She reads the letter aloud to Ela in person.
 - c. She never speaks to Ela again.
 - d. She gives the letter to a teacher.
7. Put the words in order: shouldn't / it / like / have / that / left / they
8. In the listening 'A Difficult Conversation', what does Kaan realise he could have done instead of the joke?
 - a. Stayed silent
 - b. Complimented Buse's work
 - c. Left the party
 - d. Told a different joke
9. She _____ (not / know) about the surprise; she was out of town all week.

Support

1. Write 4 sentences about things you should have done differently last week, using should have / shouldn't have.
2. Match 6 new vocabulary words from this theme to their Turkish meanings.
3. Complete a simple gap-fill worksheet with should have / could have (teacher-provided).
4. Listen again to 'A Difficult Conversation' and write down 3 phrases Kaan or Buse used to express regret.

Core

1. Write a short paragraph (80-100 words) about a decision you regret, using at least 3 modal perfect structures.
2. Write 5 sentences guessing what might have happened in a mystery situation of your choice.
3. Choose 8 vocabulary words from this theme and write original sentences with each.
4. Prepare 3 discussion questions about 'Who Forgot the Cake?' to ask a classmate.

Extension

1. Write a 150-word dialogue between two people who disagree about what must have happened in a past situation.
2. Research and note down 3 English idioms related to regret or apologising, and explain their meanings in your own words.
3. Write an alternative ending to 'The Letter I Never Sent' using at least 4 modal perfect structures.
4. Record yourself (or practise aloud) giving advice to a friend about a mistake, using should have and could have naturally.

Vocabulary

1. Which word describes carrying a heavy emotional weight?
 - a. burden
 - b. excuse
 - c. assumption
 - d. reassure
2. He tried to _____ for his mistake by helping her every day that week.
3. Which word means 'easily hurt or emotionally exposed'?
 - a. vulnerable
 - b. considerate
 - c. distant
 - d. thoughtless

Grammar

1. You _____ so harsh with your comment; it upset everyone.
 - a. shouldn't have been
 - b. mustn't be
 - c. couldn't be
 - d. shouldn't be
2. The lights are on, so someone _____ (be) home.
3. Rewrite using might have: Perhaps she forgot to bring her homework. (*She ____*)

Reading

1. In 'Who Forgot the Cake?', who was actually responsible for the missing cake?
 - a. Uncle Kemal
 - b. Mert
 - c. The bakery
 - d. Grandma
2. Grandma was very upset about the missing cake. — *True / False*

Listening

1. In 'The Empty Classroom', who had actually used the room the evening before?
 - a. The cleaning staff
 - b. The drama club
 - c. Another class
 - d. No one

2. The teacher says the students _____ (cause) the mess since they weren't even there.

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Speaking

1. Which phrase is most appropriate for softening criticism in speech?

- a. You always ruin everything.
- b. You could have handled that a bit better, maybe.
- c. That was completely your fault.
- d. Why would you even do that?

Writing

1. Which sentence best fits a paragraph expressing regret about a past decision?

- a. I should have listened to her advice.
- b. I am listening to her advice now.
- c. I will listen to her advice.
- d. I listen to her advice every day.